

West Indies batting strength, Afghan spin stars and high-flying Kiwis

THE PRESENCE OF PAPUA NEW GUINEA AND UGANDA ADDS A POTENTIAL FOR UPSETS.

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Group C of the T20 World Cup features an intriguing three-team battle between New Zealand, West Indies, and Afghanistan for the top two spots. Additionally, the presence of Papua New Guinea and Uganda adds a potential for upsets. Each of the top three teams in this group has distinct strengths: New Zealand is a balanced squad, Afghanistan relies more on its bowlers, and West Indies has opted for a batting-heavy side.

New Zealand doesn't surprise anymore

Kane Williamson will play his sixth T20 World Cup — fourth as captain — while Tim Southee is set for his seventh appearance and Trent Boult for his fifth.

Unsurprisingly, the Kiwis have opted for experience, and it reflects in their selection process: only two players, Rachin Ravindra and Matt Henry, haven't played in a T20 World Cup before.

"I think when you go to World Cups, you want experience, and you want people who know what it's like," coach Gary Stead said after the squad announcement.

The Black Caps are yet to win a T20 World Cup; their best performance was the runners-up finish in the 2021

edition. New Zealand is a team known for its ability to adapt rather than following a set template. It will have to adapt quickly, as the last time a New Zealand team played in the Caribbean was in August 2022. Its first match will be against Afghanistan in Guyana. If New Zealand loses, its next match against West Indies will become doubly important.

Can Afghanistan spin it to win it?

Despite New Zealand being the favourite to top the group, Afghanistan has a good chance due to the three venues where the five teams will play during the group stage — Guyana, Tarouba, and Gros Islet — where spinners have had good economy rates in the last two

